

Wednesday, 3 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light rain 19° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 18° 12°	MANCHESTER Rain 18° 13°	GLASGOW Drizzle 15° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Starmer uses disappearing messages on his phone, No 10 confirms.

A batch of messages between ministers and Lord Mandelson were published on Monday - but there were only a few from the prime minister.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Tata Steel staff steal £1.2m of tin from work and sell it for scrap.

Three steelworkers and an accomplice took 50 tonnes of tin ingots from the Tata site when it was quiet.

UK · NEWS
- 3

Police bodycam shows officers handcuffing stabbed student as he lay dying.

Henry Nowak was handcuffed after his killer Vickrum Digwa lied and claimed he was racially abused by the teen.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1** **Endless creepy yellow corridors, 30bn TikTok views - and now a Hollywood film.**
YouTuber Kane Parsons' eerie YouTube series has been adapted for a film called Backrooms.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2** **'Men written by women': How ice hockey romances like Off Campus became TV's hottest new genre.**
The Amazon Prime adaptation of Elle Kennedy's ice hockey romance book is an early hit with viewers.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3** **Married at First Sight UK allegations 'deeply disturbing', says watchdog.**
Ofcom says it is taking the the allegations against the Channel 4 programme "very seriously".
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Humble, powerful, ready - Semenyo returns to where World Cup rise began.**
Before heading to the World Cup with Ghana, a friendly against Wales brings Manchester City's Antoine Semenyo back to Newport where he first caught the eye.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Sir Kenny Dalglish undergoing treatment for cancer.**
Scotland, Liverpool and Celtic great Sir Kenny Dalglish confirms he is undergoing treatment for cancer.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Gordon to be oldest player at World Cup but Gunn handed No 1.**
Scotland goalkeeper Craig Gordon will be the oldest player at the World Cup this summer, but the 43-year-old has not been handed the number one shirt.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Watch as Celtic beat Rangers in Women's Scottish Cup final.**
Watch as a Morgan Cross goal is enough to give Celtic victory over Rangers in the Women's Scottish Cup final despite a red card for Emma Lawton.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 2 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 3 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 4 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 5 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 6 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 7 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you could only listen to one song for the rest of your life, what is it?**
Talk-back: pick one. No 'depends on the mood'. Just one song forever — go.

- **What's the most British thing you've ever done?**
Talk-back: bonus points for the apology, the queue and the cup of tea all in one anecdote.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Sport.** A grassroots football club in the Lake District plays its home games on a pitch with a 1-in-12 slope at one end — the steepest legal gradient for organised football.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A 5-a-side league in Slough has banned all 'celebration sliding' after three players in one season tore their shorts and demanded refunds.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.01 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.01 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds — about the same as 100 elephants. They float because they're spread across miles of sky.
- Honey never spoils. Edible honey has been found in 3,000-year-old Egyptian tombs.
- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood. Two pump blood through the gills, the third pumps it round the body.
- The Eiffel Tower can grow up to 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in the heat.
- The dot above a lowercase 'i' or 'j' has a name — it's called a tittle.
- Bananas are technically berries. Strawberries, somehow, are not.
- Wombats produce cube-shaped poo. Scientists worked out it's the elasticity of their intestines.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second. So 'back in a jiffy' is the fastest promise you can make.

On this day

Day 154 of the year, 211 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Lwanga and Companions (Roman Catholic Church), and its related observances: Martyrs' Day (Uganda); Christian feast day: Clotilde; Christian feast day: Blessed Francis Ingleby; Christian feast day: Juan Grande Román. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1945 — Bill Paterson, Scottish actor
- 1942 — Curtis Mayfield, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 1999)
- 1924 — Jimmy Rogers, American singer and guitarist (died 1997)
- 1989 — Imogen Poots, English actress and model
- 1998 — Sam Curran, English cricketer
- 1964 — Kerry King, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1950 — Suzi Quatro, American-English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1946 — Michael Clarke, American drummer (died 1993)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1942 — World War II: Japan begins the Aleutian Islands Campaign by bombing Unalaska Island.
- 1998 — After suffering a mechanical failure, a high speed train derails at Eschede, Germany, killing 101 people.
- 2013 — At least 119 people are killed in a fire at a poultry farm in Jilin Province in northeastern China.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1963 — Soldiers of the South Vietnamese Army attack protesting Buddhists in Huế with liquid chemicals from tear-gas grenades, causing 67 people to be hospitalized for blistering of the skin and respiratory ailments.
- 1980 — The 1980 Grand Island tornado outbreak hits Nebraska, United States, causing five deaths and \$300 million (equivalent to \$1172 million in 2025) worth of damage.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2013 — The trial of United States Army private Chelsea Manning for leaking classified material to WikiLeaks begins in Fort Meade, Maryland.

1943 — In Los Angeles, California, white U.S. Navy sailors and Marines attack Latino youths in the five-day Zoot Suit Riots.

- 1998 — After suffering a mechanical failure, a high speed train derailed at Eschede, Germany, killing 101 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 155 of the year, 210 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Antoni Zawistowski; Christian feast day: Filippo Smaldone; Christian feast day: Francis Caracciolo; Christian feast day: Optatus. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Angelina Jolie, American actress, filmmaker, humanitarian, and activist
- 2004 — Mackenzie Ziegler, American child actress, dancer, and recording artist
- 1934 — Daphne Sheldrick, Kenyan-British conservationist and author (died 2018)
- 1970 — Dave Pybus, English bass player and songwriter
- 1981 — Gary Taylor-Fletcher, English footballer
- 1971 — Noah Wyle, American actor and producer
- 1984 — Stuart Kettlewell, Scottish football manager and former player
- 1932 — John Drew Barrymore, American actor (died 2004)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Solidarity's victory in the 1989 Polish legislative election occurs, the first election since the Communist Polish United Workers' Party abandoned its monopoly of power. It sparks off the Revolutions of 1989 in Eastern Europe.
- 1989 — The 1989 Tiananmen Square protests are suppressed in Beijing by the People's Liberation Army, with between 241 and 10,000 dead (an unofficial estimate).
- 2025 — Eleven people are killed and 56 people are injured during a crowd crush incident outside M.Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bengaluru, India for the celebration of Royal Challengers Bengaluru's Indian Premier League victory.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The United States Fifth Army captures Rome, although much of the German Fourteenth Army is able to withdraw to the north.
- 1998 — Terry Nichols is sentenced to life in prison for his role in the Oklahoma City bombing.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)